Category Policy Addendum: Home & Kitchen

KARTWAY OPERATIONAL POLICY MANUAL ## ADDENDUM HK-2026-04: HOME & KITCHEN CATEGORY RULES Effective Date: 1 April 2026 Applies To: All Tier 1, Tier 2, and Specialist Support Agents Supersedes: Version HK-2025-11

1.0 RETURN WINDOW AND TIMELINES 1.1 The return window for all Home & Kitchen items is 30 days from the verified delivery date. This matches the general Kartway marketplace standard return window; no category-specific extensions apply. 1.2 Return authorization requests submitted past the 30-day threshold shall be systematically rejected by the support queue tooling unless an approved warranty claim applies under Section 6.0. 1.3 Customers must ship authorized returns within 14 calendar days of generating the return label. Failure to drop off the item within this timeframe invalidates the return authorization.

2.0 CATEGORY-SPECIFIC CONDITION REQUIREMENTS 2.1 Cookware and Bakeware: Items exhibiting scratching on non-stick coatings, thermal warping, or grease residue exceeding 5% of the total surface area are ineligible for return. 2.2 Small Kitchen Appliances (Blenders, Mixers, Toasters): Motor bases and heating elements must be free of food particulate. Appliances returned with internal food debris in the blade assembly or heating chamber shall be assessed a sanitation fee under Section 4.0. 2.3 Bedding and Linens: Items must be unwashed, unused, and free of human or pet hair, odors, and stains. Bedding removed from its sealed vacuum packaging may only be returned if defective upon arrival. 2.4 Furniture (Indoor and Outdoor): Assembled furniture must be disassembled and packed flat if returning due to buyer remorse. Items showing fastener stripping, structural cracking, or surface gouging exceeding 2 millimeters in depth are ineligible for standard return.

3.0 ORIGINAL PACKAGING MANDATE 3.1 Original manufacturer packaging (inner box, molded pulp inserts, and styrofoam bracing) is mandatory for all major kitchen appliances, glassware, and ceramic dinnerware valued over $75.00. 3.2 Returns received without the mandatory original packaging for items exceeding the $75.00 threshold shall be rejected at the warehouse dock and returned to the customer at their expense, or subject to a mandatory disposal fee of $25.00. 3.3 For items valued under $75.00, original packaging is encouraged but not mandatory, provided the item is packed in a corrugated box with at least 2 inches of bubble wrap or packing paper on all sides.

4.0 RESTOCKING FEES 4.1 A standard restocking fee of 15% of the purchase price shall be deducted from the refund total for all opened, non-defective large kitchen appliances (espresso machines, stand mixers, air fryers) returned after

use. 4.2 A restocking fee of 20% applies to any assembled furniture item returned under buyer remorse where all original hardware components are not returned sorted in their original sealed bags. 4.3 Restocking fees are waived if the return reason is "Defective," "Damaged in Transit," or "Wrong Item Received."

5.0 HAZARDOUS AND PERISHABLE HANDLING RULES 5.1 Cast Iron and Carbon Steel: Items shipped pre-seasoned must be sealed in protective oil paper to prevent oxidation during return transit. 5.2 Perishables and Consumables: Food items, spices, meal kits, and beverage syrups are strictly non-returnable and non-refundable unless compromised by transit contamination reported within 48 hours of delivery. Agents must issue an immediate refund without requesting physical return for verified perishable spoilage claims. 5.3 Propane and Butane Appliances: Portable camp stoves and gas grills containing residual fuel canisters are classified as hazardous materials and cannot be accepted via standard parcel carriers. Agents must direct the customer to local hazardous waste disposal sites and issue a full refund upon receipt of the disposal certificate, bypassing the standard warehouse return process.

6.0 WARRANTY PERIOD 6.1 The standard Kartway operational warranty for unbranded or white-label Home & Kitchen goods is 90 days from the date of purchase against manufacturing defects. 6.2 Branded manufacturer warranties supersede Kartway’s policy where the manufacturer offers a longer term. Agents must direct customers to the manufacturer for claims exceeding the 90-day Kartway window, except where the merchant participates in the Kartway Extended Protection Program (KEPP). 6.3 For merchants enrolled in KEPP, the warranty period is extended to 1 year for small electric kitchen appliances, during which Kartway funds the repair or replacement logistics.